

Peer Review Expectations

During this course, Students will be expected to complete Peer Reviews for both their Project Proposal and their Final Project report. This is meant to give students exposure to the types of open-ended feedback present with a true academic paper review and balance the requirements necessary for assigning a grade to a paper.

Your final grade on an assignment will be the average grade of your peer reviews. TA's will also review projects and add additional reviews where necessary to ensure students have appropriate feedback and any outliers are handled.

To that end, we share the following requirements for both:

Project Proposal

The proposal is setup as a pacing check to ensure students are on track and heading in the right direction for their final project. Project Proposal peer review should include the Proposal grading rubric and feedback directly related to the project you're reviewing.

Proposal Rubric

- Q1 - 2 Pts: Does this proposal include a problem statement? (2pts)
- Q2 - 1 Pt: Does this proposal include a proposed methodology? (1pt)
- Q3 - 1 Pt: Does this proposal include planned evaluation strategies? (1pt)
- Q4 - 1Pt: Does this proposal have at least two pages, not including references? (1pt)

Proposal Peer Review Expectation

An example of an appropriate proposal Peer Review:

2/2 Project Includes Problem Statement

1/1 Project includes proposed methodology

1/1 Project includes planned evaluation strategies

1/1 Project includes at least two full pages

Really interesting proposal focusing on X topic, exploring Y models looks like an unique approach to take. Have you considered using Y evaluation methodology? Also, What stands out about your specific project to make it unique from other research? Overall this looks like it will be a great project, be sure to fully explain Z section as it is a bit confusing in this proposal.

Final Project

The final project will be graded out of 20 points on the following scale. Each section can be graded between 1 and 5:

Final Project Rubric

- (5 Points) Creativity and Project Scope
 - Evaluate the project on how unique and innovative it is. Projects that include new ideas or incremental improvements should score higher than replications of existing research. Scope will refer to whether a projects content and complexity accurately reflects the expectations based on group size, i.e. a three-person group should be expected to provide a more detailed and complex project than a 1-person group.
- (5 Points) Formulation
 - Measure of the extent to which the project is grounded in existing theories or models. This will be used to grade the theoretical foundation of the paper, demonstrating the level of understanding regarding the subject matter
- (5 Points) Rigor of Implementation
 - Assesses the technical quality and sophistication of the projects implementation. This will measure how well the project was executed, does the paper demonstrate a level of problem solving in adapting to challenges, and how effectively the project was brought to its final complete state.
- (5 Points) Report Writing Quality
 - This should measure how clearly and coherently the project is communicated. This includes well written arguments and a logical flow through the paper, along with overall presentation such as use of visual aids (charts, graphs, tables), well formatted, and free of grammar errors and typos.

Final Project Peer Review expectation

- (1 Points) Bare minimum effort in completing your peer review. Equivalent to providing a “20/20” peer review
- (2 Points) Followed the Final Project Grading rubric, breaking down the given score based on each section of the Rubric.
- (2 Points) Quality comment provided as part of your peer review. This would involve giving at least 1-2 Sentences regarding your fellow students' topic and their specific modeling approach. This can be either included in the above rubric, or as a separate line in your comment after the rubric.

An example of a Final Project Peer review that would meet all requirements is as follows:

Total: 18/20

4/5 Creativity and Project Scope: Overall an interesting project, though not enough detail was provided to explain what really makes your project stand out from existing research or analysis.

5/5 Formulation: Great job demonstrating your understanding of how to apply XXX Model!

4/5 Rigor of Implementation: Your overall implementation is good, but I would have liked to see additional follow through on your conclusion. How can this be used, or how can your

implementation be repeated?

5/5 Report Writing Quality: Great job on presenting a well formatted paper, the graphs made your results clear to understand!

Overall, a great project! You showed clear understanding of XXX project topic, and the XXX models you explored were an innovative approach. Your final evaluation has led to some interesting conclusions on XXX, which could be further explored.

Difference in Peer Review opinions

In addition, we'd like to address a common occurrence in academic publications and our course – the possibility of contrasting comments from peer reviewers. This variation in feedback is quite common, especially in all real-world publication peer reviews. It is influenced by several factors:

- **Reviewer Expertise:** A reviewer with specialized knowledge in a project's domain may have higher expectations, potentially leading to a more critical assessment.
- **Diverse Understanding:** Conversely, a reviewer less familiar with the project's subject matter might offer feedback that seems less targeted or more general.
- **Student Backgrounds:** In our class, you come from a wide array of academic and professional backgrounds. This diversity naturally leads to a range of perspectives in your reviews.
- **Inherent Subjectivity:** There's always an element of personal bias and variance in any review process.

Rest assured; our peer review system is designed with these considerations. TA's will review both your projects and the peer evaluations. We aim to ensure that the final grades reflect our course standards and are fair and balanced, accommodating the diverse viewpoints and expertise levels of all reviewers.

Thank you for your engagement and thoughtful contributions to the peer review process; Please remember to always use your best judgement when reviewing.